

FORM TP 2007177



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MAY/JUNE 2007

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
ADVANCED PROFICIENCY EXAMINATION

COMMUNICATION STUDIES

PAPER 02

2 hours 30 minutes

10 MAY 2007 (p.m.)

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Answer ALL questions.

SECTION A

MODULE 1 – GATHERING AND PROCESSING INFORMATION

Read the extract below then answer the question that follows.

The Leap Year Superstition

The first time I heard about this superstition was when I mentioned to my mother that this year was a leap year.

“Oh, plenty people ah go dead this year,” she said.

- 5 Her rather pessimistic assumption startled me. Why would anyone think that because it was a leap year, more people were going to die? Thinking my mother had listened to too many tall tales, I casually mentioned the myth to a friend.

“Yea, a so me hear all the time, leap years are bad luck,” she said.

Well, I had never heard such a thing. How many people believed this?

- 10 Intrigued, I proceeded to conduct an informal survey. I was surprised at how many people of all ages held the same view. One person even said that it was already evident, pointing to the spate of killings in Spanish Town since the beginning of the year.

But was there any other evidence that suggested that this was a true phenomenon?

- 15 My first stop, after the Internet, was a sociologist, hoping he could answer my question – where do people come up with this stuff? Professor Barry Chevannes is the Dean of the Faculty of Social Sciences at the University of the West Indies, Mona campus. He told me that folklore is sometimes based on fact, so I launched a fact-finding mission.

The Statistical Institute of Jamaica has on its website the death rates in Jamaica for the years 1991 to 2002. That time frame gave me three leap years to study, 1992 and 1996 and 2000.

- 20 And here are the facts according to www.statinja.com. In 1991 the death rate was 5.6 per 1 000 mean population. In 1992 it was 5.5; 1993, 5.7; 1995, 6.2; 1996, 6.7; 1997, 6.0; 1999, 6.8; 2000, 6.3; while in 2001 it was 6.2. So with the exception of 1996, there was no noticeable rise in deaths in Jamaica during a leap year. Actually, the rates seemed to drop during the leap year.

- 25 I’m sure many people’s hearts are lighter now. So here’s some more good news. It’s also said that the only time for a woman to propose marriage without bad luck is in a leap year. But don’t plan your wedding in a leap year though, or there’s sure to be some bad luck. Or so the legend goes.

1. (a) State the writer’s main point in no more than 30 words.
- (b) Write an ESSAY of no more than 500 words in which you identify the writer’s purpose, and comment on the strategies and language techniques used to achieve this purpose.

Total 25 marks

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MODULE 2 – LANGUAGE AND COMMUNITY

Read the extract below then answer the question that follows.

With great dignity she slowly mounted the steps of the Housing Office in town. The chief clerk in the office greeted her politely and offered her a chair.

He remembered his boyhood days when he would buy three oranges for a penny from Tantie's tray in the market.

5 'Tantie, I am glad you came in answer to my letter. We have a little matter to settle.'

He stretched out his bare knees and long stockinged legs under the desk. Tantie remained silent.

'I know how you feel to leave the old place. But never mind, we'll fix you up snug and nice.'

10 'Me old house is good enough for me, thank you. I ain't going nowhere.'

'Yes, Tantie, but you won't be able to stay there when they build the road and all the heavy lorries and taxis start passing along there.'

He pleaded but Tantie remained adamant.

'All right Tantie. We'll see what can be done.'

15 'Any luck?' asked his assistant coming in from the adjoining room after she had gone.

'No use arguing. I think we'll just have to move the old girl bodily.'

*Monica Skeete, The Road
Thomas Nelson & Son Ltd., 1982, pp. 115–116.*

2. In an ESSAY of no more than 500 words, discuss the following:

- (a) The different ways in which the clerk and Tantie use language
- (b) The various social factors responsible for the tension in the interaction they have
- (c) How a video presentation would highlight that tension

Total 25 marks

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SECTION C

MODULE 3 – SPEAKING AND WRITING

Read the following scenario, then answer the question that follows.

3. You recently joined an advertising firm. You have been assigned to a team that must design an advertisement promoting a named vegetable product aimed at pre-teens and teenagers. You are aware that pre-teens and teenagers generally dislike vegetables of any sort. You are told that parents should also be considered part of your target audience. There is a bonus for the team that comes up with the best proposal.

In ESSAY format, write a PROPOSAL for the advertisement that you will present to your teammates for consideration. Your proposal must include the following:

- (a) The information about the product, including the name
- (b) Language codes and register you would consider appropriate
- (c) Visual presentation of the product
- (d) The medium for presenting the advertisement

Total 25 marks

END OF TEST

